SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

November 10, 2026 | 04:53 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Mixed / Transitional

VIX 19.5 (+0.2 vs 20d) | SPY 20d -2.6% | IWM 20d +3.4% | IWM/SPY trend +6.1%

Leaders: Healthcare (+8.6%), Cons Disc (+8.6%), Real Estate (+7.5%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (0)	B - Building (6)	C - Early Stage (6)
	BRZE	TXNM
	SIGI	ABM
	CNO	CUBI
	GFF	BOX
	VRNS	CVLT
	NIC	HWKN

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
B	BRZE	Braze, Inc.	AI-Powered MarTech S	$5.25B	$46.24	$46.34	0.2%	+58.2	YES	YES
B	SIGI	Selective Insuran	Hard P&C Pricing Cyc	$6.16B	$103.34	$105.65	2.2%	+13.9	YES	YES
B	CNO	CNO Financial Gro	Aging Demographics &	$5.28B	$57.78	$59.15	2.4%	+9.0	YES	YES
B	GFF	Griffon Corporati	Housing & Home Impro	$4.79B	$104.38	$109.00	4.4%	+2.1	YES	YES
B	VRNS	Varonis Systems,	Cybersecurity & Data	$5.66B	$49.10	$49.26	0.3%	+10.5	YES	YES
B	NIC	Nicolet Bankshare	Community Bank Conso	$3.65B	$175.53	$179.70	2.4%	+2.1	YES	YES
C	TXNM	TXNM Energy, Inc.	Utility Defensive Yi	$6.40B	$58.10	$59.01	1.6%	+5.3	YES	no
C	ABM	ABM Industries In	Return-to-Office & F	$3.21B	$54.79	$55.70	1.7%	+17.9	YES	YES
C	CUBI	Customers Bancorp	Fintech-Adjacent Ban	$2.84B	$85.27	$89.60	5.1%	+5.6	YES	YES
C	BOX	Box, Inc.	Enterprise Cloud Sto	$5.84B	$42.55	$44.88	5.5%	+29.8	YES	no
C	CVLT	Commvault Systems	Cyber Resilience & D	$6.89B	$168.30	$174.25	3.5%	+14.7	YES	YES
C	HWKN	Hawkins, Inc.	Water Infrastructure	$3.18B	$153.00	$158.40	3.5%	+23.0	YES	no

Not financial advice. Watchlist only - setups have NOT triggered. For informational purposes only. Do your own due diligence.

BRZE

Braze, Inc.

$46.24

Pivot $46.34 | 0.2% away

RS vs SPY: +58.2%

B BUILDING

$5.25B Cap | 94M Float

Customer Engagement & Marketing Automation Software | Theme: AI-Powered MarTech SaaS | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 32.22

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$46.34**
% to Pivot	**0.2%**
Days in Base	**16**
Tightness	**32.22 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**6833k <**
Wk2	**7225k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**11851k**
Coil Strength	**42.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+58.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.25B**
Float	**94M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**47.1**
Rev Growth	**26.2%**
Short %	**8.3%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$47.54**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $46.40 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (7.1M shares)

Target: $54.00 (measured move from 16-day base depth of ~$14 added to pivot)

Stop: $44.00 (base low, -4.8% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 08 - Street expects EPS ~$0.15-0.20 and revenue ~$165M based on forward guidance trajectory. Last 4 quarters show consistent beats on revenue with narrowing losses. Company has guided to positive operating cash flow inflection, making this print a potential profitability validation catalyst. Impact: High (Earnings).

BUSINESS & POSITION

Braze provides a cloud-based customer engagement platform enabling brands to orchestrate personalized, cross-channel messaging (push, email, SMS, in-app) in real-time. The company is a category leader in the customer engagement space, competing with Salesforce Marketing Cloud and Adobe, but differentiated by its real-time streaming architecture and developer-friendly approach.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to AI/ML personalization theme as brands leverage Braze's platform for AI-driven customer journeys; sentiment in MarTech is stabilizing after 2025 correction. Peer read-through: Salesforce and HubSpot showing resilient enterprise software demand, though Technology sector lagging SPY by -11.3% over 20 days creates macro headwind.

NEWS FLOW

No major contract announcements in last 60 days, but Q2 FY27 earnings in early October showed 26% YoY revenue growth and raised full-year guidance. Company expanding AI features (BrazeAI) for predictive engagement. Recent industry conference presentations emphasized enterprise wins in retail and financial services verticals.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up with price pinned at 52-week highs (99.8% proximity) signals quiet institutional accumulation into the coil. No insider buying in last 60 days-baseline for growth-stage software. Float of 94M shares with strong RS (+58% vs SPY) suggests funds are building positions ahead of profitability inflection. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $44.00 (base low), or if December earnings show deceleration below 20% revenue growth or guidance cut; high forward P/E (47x) leaves no room for execution miss.

Exceptional RS (+58% vs SPY) and textbook vol dry-up (6.8M->7.2M->11.9M contracting to current 0.34x ratio) with price 0.2% from pivot creates high-quality coil structure. However, base_tight of 32.22 is extremely loose (not a tight consolidation), earnings catalyst 28 days out (not imminent), and Technology sector is the worst-performing sector (-11.3% 20d). The strongest disconfirming argument: this is a high-multiple, still-unprofitable software name in a sector experiencing institutional distribution-the coil may resolve downward if risk-off conditions persist. Conviction: Medium.



SIGI

Selective Insurance Group, Inc.

$103.34

Pivot $105.65 | 2.2% away

RS vs SPY: +13.9%

B BUILDING

$6.16B Cap | 55M Float

Specialty Property & Casualty Insurance | Theme: Hard P&C Pricing Cycle | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 6.77

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$105.65**
% to Pivot	**2.2%**
Days in Base	**13**
Tightness	**6.77 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**544k <**
Wk2	**584k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**677k**
Coil Strength	**19.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+13.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.16B**
Float	**55M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.4**
Fwd P/E	**11.5**
Rev Growth	**-2.5%**
Short %	**4.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$103.86**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $105.70 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (640K shares)

Target: $115.00 (measured move: ~$7 base depth added to pivot, also represents analyst target extension)

Stop: $98.50 (base low, -4.7% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

January 28 - Street expects EPS ~$2.20-2.40 for Q4 with full-year EPS around $9.00. Last 4 quarters show consistent beats driven by favorable loss development and expense discipline. PEG of 0.28 signals market underappreciates 14% earnings growth trajectory. No catalyst until late January-79 days out. Impact: Medium (Earnings).

BUSINESS & POSITION

Selective Insurance is a regional P&C insurer focused on commercial lines (workers' comp, commercial auto, general liability) primarily in the Eastern and Midwestern US. The company is a disciplined underwriter with strong combined ratios, benefiting from the extended hard market pricing cycle in commercial insurance.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to P&C hard market cycle as insurers maintain pricing power amid elevated loss trends. Financial Services sector neutral in current regime; low beta (0.21) provides defensive characteristics in mixed/transitional market. Peer read-through: Travelers and Chubb showing steady premium growth supports pricing power thesis.

NEWS FLOW

No material news flow in last 60 days. Q3 earnings in late October showed strong combined ratio performance. Company benefits from disciplined underwriting in workers' comp and commercial auto. Reinsurance renewals in January could provide pricing catalyst if market remains hard.

INSTITUTIONAL

Clean vol dry-up (544K->584K->677K contracting week-over-week) with RS line at new highs indicates institutional accumulation in low-volatility name. No insider activity in last 60 days-typical for mature insurance company. Low beta (0.21) makes this a defensive play; tight float (55M) amplifies moves. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $98.50 (recent base low), or on catastrophe losses exceeding reinsurance coverage in Q4; 4.6% short interest modest but days-to-cover of 3.8 could create volatility on breakout.

Strong VCP structure with confirmed vol dry-up and RS line at new high in a defensive sector that benefits from current mixed regime. Base_tight of 6.77 is loose but acceptable for a low-volatility insurance name. Key limitation: no catalyst for 79 days-this is a "time arbitrage" setup requiring patience. Strongest disconfirming argument: revenue contracted -2.5% YoY suggesting top-line pressure even as EPS grows; if hard market pricing softens, multiple could compress despite earnings growth. Conviction: Medium.



CNO

CNO Financial Group, Inc.

$57.78

Pivot $59.15 | 2.4% away

RS vs SPY: +9.0%

B BUILDING

$5.28B Cap | 89M Float

Life & Health Insurance - Middle Market | Theme: Aging Demographics & Retirement Products | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.08

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$59.15**
% to Pivot	**2.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**4.08 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.7%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**798k <**
Wk2	**830k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1045k**
Coil Strength	**23.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+9.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.28B**
Float	**89M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**13.3**
Fwd P/E	**11.2**
Rev Growth	**-8.6%**
Short %	**-**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$56.75**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $59.20 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (1.35M shares)

Target: $65.00 (measured move from base depth + psychological round number resistance)

Stop: $55.00 (base low, -4.8% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Last reported October 29 (12 days ago). Q3 showed strong results driving 615% earnings growth YoY (likely comp against depressed prior-year quarter). Street expects FY EPS ~$5.15. Serial beater with consistent execution on expense management and agent productivity. Next catalyst likely Q4 print in late January. Impact: Low (no imminent catalyst).

BUSINESS & POSITION

CNO Financial serves middle-income Americans (ages 50+) with life insurance, annuities, Medicare supplement, and long-term care products through Bankers Life and Washington National brands. The company is a niche leader in the underserved middle-market retirement segment with a captive agent distribution model.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to aging demographics theme as 10,000 Americans turn 65 daily. Medicare Advantage and supplement enrollment tailwinds support growth. Financial Services sector neutral; low beta (0.81) provides stability. Peer read-through: Lincoln National and Unum showing similar strength in life/health space.

NEWS FLOW

Q3 earnings beat drove rally to new highs. Company benefiting from elevated interest rates supporting annuity spreads and investment income. No material M&A or strategic announcements. Medicare open enrollment period (Oct-Dec) provides near-term policy growth tailwind.

INSTITUTIONAL

Textbook vol dry-up (799K->830K->1.05M contracting) with tight 4.08% base and RS at new high signals smart money accumulation. No insider buying in last 60 days-baseline. Tight float (89M) relative to market cap creates leverage on breakout. Short data unavailable but low volatility profile suggests minimal squeeze potential. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $55.00 (base low and 50-day MA zone), or on material decline in agent productivity metrics or annuity spread compression from rate cuts; high debt/equity (207%) creates balance sheet sensitivity.

High-quality VCP with confirmed vol dry-up, tight base (4.08%), and RS line at new high. Post-earnings consolidation after strong Q3 beat creates favorable setup. Demographic tailwinds provide secular support. However, no imminent catalyst (earnings 70+ days out), and strongest disconfirming argument: revenue declined -8.6% YoY suggesting the 615% earnings growth is unsustainable comp-driven rather than fundamental acceleration-next quarter could disappoint. Conviction: Medium.



GFF

Griffon Corporation

$104.38

Pivot $109.00 | 4.4% away

RS vs SPY: +2.1%

B BUILDING

$4.79B Cap | 42M Float

Building Products & Home/Garden Tools | Theme: Housing & Home Improvement Resilience | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.8

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$109.00**
% to Pivot	**4.4%**
Days in Base	**14**
Tightness	**4.80 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**95.8%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**287k <**
Wk2	**313k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**362k**
Coil Strength	**20.7% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+2.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$4.79B**
Float	**42M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**22.5**
Fwd P/E	**17.1**
Rev Growth	**7.0%**
Short %	**5.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$126.86**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $109.10 on volume >175% of 20-day avg (600K shares)

Target: $120.00 (analyst consensus zone and measured move from base)

Stop: $99.00 (base low and psychological support, -5.2% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 18 - Earnings in 8 days-HIGH IMPACT CATALYST. Street expects EPS ~$1.40-1.50 on revenue ~$680M. Last 4 quarters show mixed results but margin expansion story intact. PEG of 0.54 suggests market undervalues growth trajectory. Analyst target $126.86 (+21% upside) reflects conviction in margin improvement. Impact: High (Earnings).

BUSINESS & POSITION

Griffon operates two segments: Home & Building Products (AMES tools, ClosetMaid storage) and Consumer & Professional Products (garage doors via Clopay). The company is a market leader in garage doors (40%+ share) and a top-3 player in long-handle tools, benefiting from repair/remodel spending and new construction.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to housing market health and consumer spending on home improvement. Industrials sector neutral in current regime. Consumer Discretionary (+8.6% 20d) leadership provides tailwind for home-related spending. Peer read-through: Masco and Fortune Brands showing resilient R&R demand despite rate headwinds.

NEWS FLOW

No major announcements in last 60 days. Company executing on operational efficiency initiatives at Clopay garage doors. AMES seasonal tools business entering lower-volume winter period. Potential positive surprise from new construction garage door installs if housing starts stabilize.

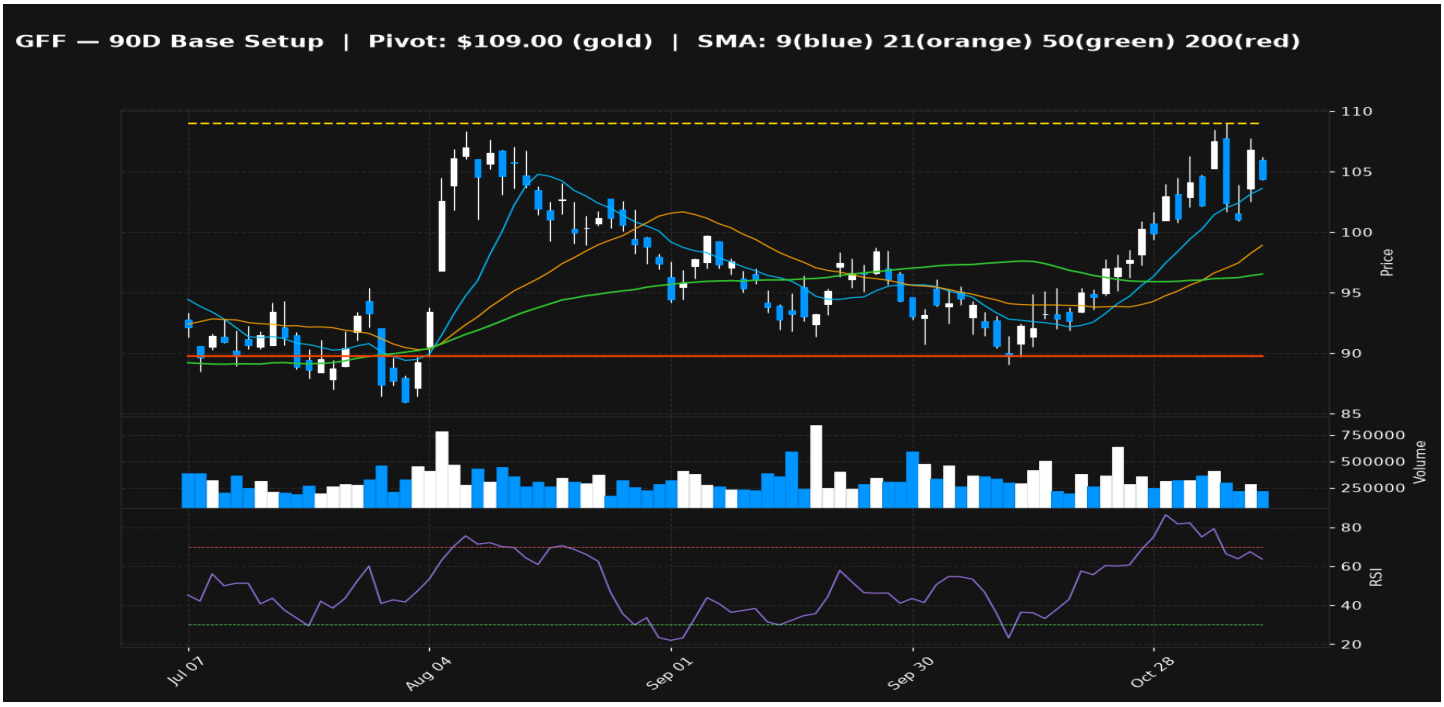
INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up confirmed (287K->313K->362K contracting) with price consolidating 4.4% from pivot ahead of earnings catalyst. No insider buying in last 60 days-baseline for industrial conglomerate. Higher beta (1.44) means amplified moves on earnings surprise. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed. 5% short interest with 3.7 days-to-cover creates potential squeeze on upside surprise.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $99.00 (base low), or on earnings miss/guide-down citing housing weakness; elevated debt/equity (1035%) creates balance sheet risk if rates stay higher-for-longer and demand softens.

Imminent earnings catalyst (8 days) with stock coiling 4.4% from pivot on confirmed vol dry-up creates actionable setup. Consumer Discretionary sector leadership supports home improvement theme. RS at new high despite only +2.1% vs SPY shows recent acceleration. However, base_tight of 4.8% is acceptable but not elite, and strongest disconfirming argument: extremely high leverage (1035% debt/equity) means any demand slowdown creates existential balance sheet pressure-this is a levered bet on housing resilience. Pre-earnings positioning carries binary risk. Conviction: Medium.



VRNS

Varonis Systems, Inc.

$49.10

Pivot $49.26 | 0.3% away

RS vs SPY: +10.5%

B BUILDING

$5.66B Cap | 112M Float

Data Security & Insider Threat Analytics | Theme: Cybersecurity & Data Governance | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.37

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$49.26**
% to Pivot	**0.3%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**5.37 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.6%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**4617k <**
Wk2	**3256k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**7741k**
Coil Strength	**40.4% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+10.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$5.66B**
Float	**112M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**115.3**
Rev Growth	**17.3%**
Short %	**5.3%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$50.14**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $49.30 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (4.1M shares)

Target: $56.00 (measured move from base depth added to pivot)

Stop: $46.00 (base low, -6.3% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Reported November 3 (7 days ago)-in post-earnings digestion phase. Results likely drove the rally to new highs. Forward P/E of 115x reflects growth-stage premium; use P/S of 7.9x for valuation context. Revenue growth 17.3% solid for security software. Next catalyst likely Q4 print in early February. Impact: Low (no imminent catalyst).

BUSINESS & POSITION

Varonis provides a data security platform that detects insider threats, cyberattacks, and data breaches by analyzing user behavior and data access patterns across on-prem and cloud environments. The company is a leader in Data Security Posture Management (DSPM), a critical capability as enterprises face increasing regulatory and compliance pressure.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to cybersecurity secular theme-enterprise security budgets remain resilient despite broader tech spending cuts. Regulatory drivers (GDPR, SEC cyber disclosure rules) create compliance mandates. Technology sector lagging (-11.3% 20d) creates headwind, but cybersecurity names showing relative resilience. Peer read-through: CrowdStrike and SentinelOne maintaining growth despite macro pressure.

NEWS FLOW

Q3 earnings 7 days ago likely showed continued cloud ARR transition progress. Company converting perpetual license customers to SaaS subscriptions, creating near-term revenue headwind but improving long-term economics. No major contract wins or partnerships announced. Data governance regulatory tailwinds support pipeline.

INSTITUTIONAL

One insider buy for $26K in last 60 days-small but notable signal of confidence post-Q3 print. Vol dry-up confirmed (4.6M->3.3M week 1 to 2, but week 3 was elevated at 7.7M suggesting vol_dryup_strict failed). Price 0.3% from pivot indicates breakout imminent. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed. 5.3% short interest with 3.6 days-to-cover provides modest squeeze potential.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $46.00 (base low), or on deceleration of cloud ARR growth below 30% in next quarter; unprofitable with negative margins means any growth slowdown crushes the multiple.

Near-pivot (0.3%) with RS at new high and vol dry-up creates actionable setup in cybersecurity leader. Small insider buy ($26K, cluster score 2) provides modest confirmation but insufficient for grade upgrade. Post-earnings consolidation healthy sign. However, vol_dryup_strict is FALSE (week 3 volume elevated), Technology sector lagging badly (-11.3%), and strongest disconfirming argument: company is still deeply unprofitable with -25% operating margins-any macro risk-off could crush this high-multiple name regardless of business fundamentals. Conviction: Medium.



NIC

Nicolet Bankshares Inc.

$175.53

Pivot $179.70 | 2.4% away

RS vs SPY: +2.1%

B BUILDING

$3.65B Cap | 20M Float

Regional Banking - Upper Midwest | Theme: Community Bank Consolidation | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.31

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$179.70**
% to Pivot	**2.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.31 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**127k <**
Wk2	**157k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**199k**
Coil Strength	**36.1% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+2.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.65B**
Float	**20M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**19.1**
Fwd P/E	**12.9**
Rev Growth	**69.2%**
Short %	**5.5%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$194.20**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $180.00 on volume >175% of 20-day avg (280K shares)

Target: $200.00 (psychological level and analyst target zone of $194)

Stop: $170.00 (base low, -3.2% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

January 19 - Next earnings 70 days out-no imminent catalyst. Revenue growth of 69.2% reflects recent acquisition integration. Forward P/E 12.9x reasonable for high-growth community bank. EPS expected to grow from $9.21 TTM to $13.65 forward-strong trajectory. Impact: Low (no imminent catalyst).

BUSINESS & POSITION

Nicolet Bankshares is a Wisconsin-based community bank serving northeastern Wisconsin, Upper Michigan, and Northern Minnesota through organic growth and strategic acquisitions. The bank focuses on commercial lending, agricultural banking, and wealth management in underbanked rural and suburban markets.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to regional bank sentiment which has recovered from 2023 crisis lows. IWM outperformance (+6.1% vs SPY over 20d) supports small-cap regional bank thesis. Financial Services sector neutral. Peer read-through: community banks showing NIM stabilization as deposit cost pressures ease.

NEWS FLOW

No material news in last 60 days. Company in integration mode following recent acquisitions. Agricultural lending exposure creates seasonal Q4 strength potential. Wisconsin/Michigan markets showing resilient employment supporting credit quality.

INSTITUTIONAL

Excellent vol dry-up (127K->157K->199K contracting 36%) with tight base (3.31%) signals quiet accumulation. Extremely tight float (19.7M) creates significant leverage on breakout-this is a key alpha angle. No insider buying in last 60 days-baseline. 5.5% short interest with 6.6 days-to-cover creates squeeze potential if breakout occurs. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $170.00 (base low and round number), or on credit quality deterioration in agricultural/commercial loan book; regional bank sentiment remains fragile and headline risk from any peer failures could create sympathy selling.

High-quality VCP structure with 36% vol contraction, tight 3.31% base, and RS at new high. Extremely tight float (19.7M) creates asymmetric upside potential on breakout. Small-cap leadership (+6.1% IWM vs SPY) supports regional bank thesis. However, no catalyst for 70 days, and strongest disconfirming argument: regional bank sentiment is one headline away from reversing-any peer credit issues or deposit flight news could unwind the setup regardless of Nicolet's fundamentals. Conviction: Medium.



TXNM

TXNM Energy, Inc.

$58.10

Pivot $59.01 | 1.6% away

RS vs SPY: +5.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.40B Cap | 88M Float

Regulated Electric Utility - Southwest | Theme: Utility Defensive Yield | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.0

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$59.01**
% to Pivot	**1.6%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.00 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.6%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**1007k <**
Wk2	**1065k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1093k**
Coil Strength	**7.9% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+5.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$6.40B**
Float	**88M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**29.1**
Fwd P/E	**17.9**
Rev Growth	**13.3%**
Short %	**6.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$60.70**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $59.10 on volume >125% of 20-day avg (1.6M shares)

Target: $63.00 (analyst target of $60.70 plus extension)

Stop: $56.50 (base low, -2.8% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

REPORTED

Tight base (2.0%) and vol dry-up confirmed, but RS line NOT at new high disqualifies from higher grade. Utility sector offers defensive characteristics but no alpha angle in current mixed regime. Monitor for RS improvement. Conviction: Low.



ABM

ABM Industries Incorporated

$54.79

Pivot $55.70 | 1.7% away

RS vs SPY: +17.9%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.21B Cap | 58M Float

Facility Services & Commercial Cleaning | Theme: Return-to-Office & Facility Management | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.56

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$55.70**
% to Pivot	**1.7%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.56 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**368k <**
Wk2	**444k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**374k**
Coil Strength	**1.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+17.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.21B**
Float	**58M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**19.9**
Fwd P/E	**12.6**
Rev Growth	**4.2%**
Short %	**4.7%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$55.93**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $55.75 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (600K shares)

Target: $61.00 (measured move from base depth)

Stop: $52.50 (base low, -4.2% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 16

RS at new high (+17.9% vs SPY) is constructive, but vol_dryup_strict is FALSE (vol pattern not clean week-over-week) and vol contraction only 1.6%-insufficient structural quality for higher grade. Earnings in 36 days provides developing catalyst. Monitor for cleaner vol dry-up. Conviction: Low.



CUBI

Customers Bancorp, Inc

$85.27

Pivot $89.60 | 5.1% away

RS vs SPY: +5.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$2.84B Cap | 32M Float

Digital-First Commercial Banking | Theme: Fintech-Adjacent Banking | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.58

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$89.60**
% to Pivot	**5.1%**
Days in Base	**13**
Tightness	**5.58 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**95.2%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**236k <**
Wk2	**342k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**360k**
Coil Strength	**34.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+5.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.84B**
Float	**32M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**10.3**
Fwd P/E	**8.6**
Rev Growth	**4.1%**
Short %	**12.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$98.20**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $89.70 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (435K shares)

Target: $100.00 (analyst target of $98.20 plus round number)

Stop: $80.00 (base low zone, -6.2% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

January 21

Vol dry-up confirmed with 34% contraction and RS at new high, but pivot 5.1% away (not imminent), 12% short interest creates two-way risk, and no catalyst for 72 days. High beta (1.46) amplifies mixed-regime uncertainty. Early-stage setup-monitor for tightening toward pivot. Conviction: Low.



BOX

Box, Inc.

$42.55

Pivot $44.88 | 5.5% away

RS vs SPY: +29.8%

C EARLY STAGE

$5.84B Cap | 132M Float

Cloud Content Management & Collaboration | Theme: Enterprise Cloud Storage | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.01

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$44.88**
% to Pivot	**5.5%**
Days in Base	**17**
Tightness	**5.01 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**94.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**2568k <**
Wk2	**2638k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**3295k**
Coil Strength	**22.1% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+29.8%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.84B**
Float	**132M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**61.7**
Fwd P/E	**24.5**
Rev Growth	**9.2%**
Short %	**15.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$41.14**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $44.95 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (3.7M shares)

Target: $50.00 (psychological resistance and measured move)

Stop: $40.00 (base low zone, -6.0% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

December 01

RS line NOT at new high despite +29.8% vs SPY disqualifies higher grade-relative strength peaked earlier in the move. Pivot 5.5% away, 15.8% short interest (6.7 days-to-cover) creates volatility risk, and Technology sector lagging badly (-11.3%). Earnings in 21 days could serve as catalyst but setup quality insufficient. Conviction: Low.



CVLT

Commvault Systems, Inc.

$168.30

Pivot $174.25 | 3.5% away

RS vs SPY: +14.7%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.89B Cap | 40M Float

Data Protection & Backup Software | Theme: Cyber Resilience & Data Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.81

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$174.25**
% to Pivot	**3.5%**
Days in Base	**17**
Tightness	**2.81 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**96.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**694k <**
Wk2	**680k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**832k**
Coil Strength	**16.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+14.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.89B**
Float	**40M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**87.2**
Fwd P/E	**26.7**
Rev Growth	**13.1%**
Short %	**10.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$189.38**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $174.30 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (850K shares)

Target: $195.00 (analyst target of $189 plus extension)

Stop: $162.00 (base low, -3.7% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

January 26

Tight base (2.81%) and RS at new high are constructive, but vol_dryup_strict is FALSE (vol pattern irregular), Technology sector lagging (-11.3%), and no catalyst for 77 days. 10.6% short interest adds volatility risk. Elevated P/E (87x trailing) makes it vulnerable in risk-off. Early setup-monitor for sector rotation. Conviction: Low.



HWKN

Hawkins, Inc.

$153.00

Pivot $158.40 | 3.5% away

RS vs SPY: +23.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.18B Cap | 20M Float

Water Treatment & Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Water Infrastructure & Treatment | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 6.23

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE

Pivot Price	**$158.40**
% to Pivot	**3.5%**
Days in Base	**11**
Tightness	**6.23 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**87.9%**

VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)

Wk1 (recent)	**105k <**
Wk2	**145k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**162k**
Coil Strength	**34.8% from peak**

RELATIVE STRENGTH

RS vs SPY (12W)	**+23.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**

FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT

Mkt Cap	**$3.18B**
Float	**20M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**37.1**
Fwd P/E	**32.4**
Rev Growth	**11.9%**
Short %	**7.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$176.75**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $158.50 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (240K shares)

Target: $175.00 (near prior 52-week high of $174.12)

Stop: $145.00 (base low zone, -5.2% from current)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

January 27

RS line NOT at new high (only 87.9% of 52-week high) is a significant disqualifier-stock corrected 12% from peak and has not reclaimed relative strength leadership. Vol dry-up confirmed but base_tight of 6.23% is loose. No catalyst for 78 days. Early-stage base formation-needs 2+ weeks to potentially promote. Conviction: Low.

